

Dear Dustin,

I'm Christopher Hall, a software engineer driven by curiosity, engineering excellence, and empathetic trouble shooting. I'm currently looking for an opportunity to apply my growing engineering skills to a smaller team making a positive impact on the world.

For the past three years, I've been at Optum developing a module federation front end that hosts over 50 microapps, migrating over eight on-premises services to Azure, and leading the modernization of our CI/CD workflows, saving us hundreds of developer hours to date. Before that, I earned my B.S. in Computer Science at Duke University where I worked with the Nasher Museum of Art using Python to build out new features for a website that renders 3D virtual exhibitions. Additionally, I worked with the Duke OIT as a project manager for over 40 students, guiding their Kubernetes, React, and Ruby on Rails projects.

I'm now excited about the opportunity to continue my journey at UNCA. There are three things that make me the perfect fit for this position:

First, my journey in tech has been one of breadth, positioning me to be well suited to the varied responsibilities of this position. I am fluent with Linux systems and their provisioning. My daily work involves infrastructure and networking management in Azure. Further, I work with scripting in writing out CICD workflows. My current proficiencies already make me a good fit for the position, but it's my curiosity and ability to pick up new technologies that make me a great fit. I always make it a point to pick up new languages or frameworks when I can, building up my chops for picking things up quickly. For example, recently I was able to balance learning Drizzle ORM with utilizing it in our new application. This skill would allow me to learn the ropes quickly, eg. picking up Veeam and Cirrus fast, and start contributing in all areas ASAP.

Second, I love troubleshooting and solving problems. In my current position I get to flex this in two ways. Our team has been without a product manager for over two years now. This has given me experience owning and advocating for specific features that I identify as valuable, proposing delivery plans and following through on them. Additionally, folks with technical issues or questions will submit tickets to us. I know how frustrated folks can get when running into technical issues. That's why it's so important to approach with empathy and clarity. I'm practiced in gauging the technical abilities of my audience and framing solutions in a way that they understand, as well as being present and personable with them throughout the process. I would bring my independence, ability to grow, and empathetic troubleshooting to the IT team at UNCA.

Finally, I'm looking to have an impact working on a smaller team making a positive change in the communities that I care for. IT is an essential part of a modern education. Being a part of the team that is committed to technological equity and working to reduce the financial burden IT can have is a possibility that excites me. Even more exciting would be getting to positively impact the education of countless students in my home state of North Carolina. This is work I would be energized to be a part of.

I am excited at the opportunity to learn, grow, and contribute as a part of the IT team at UNCA. I look forward to hearing back.

Best,

Christopher Hall